



DOES TERROR HAVE A RELIGION?

“Distortions are the danger”

“The key distinction is between faith and dogma”

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Whether terrorism has a religion is actually not the question. The question is what choices any of us make in religion's name. The Hindu fanatic who assassinated Gandhiji, that Hindu chose hate; the Sikh fundamentalists who blew up the Air-India flight that killed hundreds of my fellow Canadians, those Sikhs chose hate. And Mohammed Sidique Khan, the ringleader of the July 27 bombings in London, he chose hate.

He chose hate in the name of religion, in the name of Islam. Misguided, yes! But it would be a lie to say that religion has nothing to do with any of these terrorist attacks that I just listed. Clearly terror has no particular religion but it's worth knowing that all terror, at least, has one common denominator: dogma. An uncritical, unchallenging, unquestioning approach that turns philosophies into orthodoxy. The crucial and hopeful distinction to be made here is between faith and dogma. Faith, it seems to me, is secure enough to handle questions. It never needs to be threatened by questions. Dogma, on the other hand, is always threatened by questions because by definition, it is rigid and brutal and it collapses under the spotlight of scrutiny and therefore, in my